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MEGHA PATNAIK

Contact Information
mpatnaik@luiss.it
Viale Romania 32, Rome 00197, Italy

Personal Information
Date of Birth: 14 June 1988 (New Delhi)
Citizenship: India

Website: https://meghapatnaik.github.io/
Github page: https://github.com/meghapatnaik

Current position

2020-Present
Assistant Professor, LUISS Guido Carli, Department of Economics & Finance
Research Affiliate, Centre for Economic Policy Research (CEPR) and CESifo
Co-founder, Leap Insights, and Head of the India Productivity Lab

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Stanford University, June 2017, Advisor: Nick Bloom. Committee: Chad Jones, Shai Bernstein, Isaac Sorkin, Petra Moser
M.Sc. in Econometrics & Mathematical Economics, London School of Economics, 2009-2011
B.Sc. in Mathematics, St. Stephen's College, University of Delhi, 2006-2009

Professional Experience

2025	Visiting Assistant Professor, Stanford University Department of Economics
2017-2019	Visiting Assistant Professor, Indian Statistical Institute, Economics and Planning Unit
2020-Present	Research Affiliate, Centre for Economic Policy Research
2025-Present	Research Affiliate, CESifo Research Network
2022-Present	Network of Women in Data Science & Social Science
2024-Present	Co-founder, Leap Insights; Head, India Productivity Lab
2024-Present	Co-founder, AccioPix
2024	Lecturer, Stanford University Department of Economics
2019	Fellow, Esya Centre
2018	Data Science Consultant, Britannia Inc.
2017-2018	Strategy consultant, Ambit Capital
2012-2017	Research Assistant for Nick Bloom, Department of Economics, Stanford University
2013-2017	Data Scientist, Intuit Inc., Mountain View, California, USA
2013-2018	Special Sworn Status Researcher, US Census Bureau, Maryland, USA
2013	National Bureau of Economic Research Entrepreneurship Bootcamp (Boston, USA)
2010	Research assistant for Prof. Jeff Hammer, Princeton University, USA
2007	Intern, Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Government of India

Grants, Scholarships and Awards

2026	PRIN 2026 Research Grant, Italian Ministry of University and Research (MUR), "Technology Adoption under Constraint: Finance, Governance, Labour and Policy in the European AI Transition", Associated Principal Investigator and head of the LUISS unit (€251,373 to the LUISS unit; four-university project led by Nicolas Serrano-Velarde, Bocconi University)
2026	Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance (EIEF) Research Grant (€5,000), "Mandatory Sustainability Disclosure and Firm Behavior: Evidence from India's BRSR Reform"
2025	Structural Transformation and Economic Growth Large Research Grant (£60,000)
2024	LUISS Teaching Excellence Award (2022)
2018	Indian Council of Social Science Research (ICSSR) and the Japan Society for Promotion of Science (JSPS) Joint Project (Rs. 14,00,000 and JPY 2,400,000)
2015	Kapnick Foundation scholarship at Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research Dissertation Fellowship (stipend & tuition coverage at Stanford, final year of Ph.D.)
2015	Kauffman Dissertation Fellowship Award, Kauffman Foundation ($15,000) Research Project Grant, International Growth Centre, London, UK (£9,869)
2014	Ph.D. grant, Stanford Institute for Innovation in Developing Countries, ($3,900)
2011	Department of Economics Fellowship (stipend and tuition 1st year), Stanford University

Main published and forthcoming academic papers

1. **Understanding Employee Trade-Offs in Remote Work: Toward More Sustainable Workplace Design**, with Beata Wozniak-Jechorek, Amanda Sahar d'Urso & Chloe Thurston. *Journal of Strategic Information Systems*, 2026.
2. **The international empirics of management**, with Daniela Scur, John Van Reenen, Raffaella Sadun, Lucia Foster, Scott Ohlmacher et al. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 2024.
3. **Management Practices and Resilience to Shocks: Evidence from COVID-19**, with Andrea Lamorgese, Andrea Linarello & Fabiano Schivardi. *Management Science*, 2024.
4. **Compulsory Licensing for Radio-Play of Music in India: Recent History and Economic Context** *Review of Economic Research on Copyright Issues*, 2020.
5. **What drives differences in management practices?**, with Nick Bloom, Erik Brynjolfsson, Lucia Foster, Ron Jarmin, Itay Saporta-Eksten & John Van Reenen. *American Economic Review*, 2019.

Working Papers

1. **The impact of FDIC failed bank resolutions on small business credit**. Reject and Resubmit, *Review of Finance*.
2. **Self-Enforcing Tax Design and Supply Chain Formalization: Evidence from India's GST Reform**, with Aishwarya Kamboj. Under Review.
3. **Tax, Lies and Red Tape**. Under Review.
4. **Remote Work, Spatial Constraints, and Women's Job Preferences: Evidence from a Survey Experiment in Six European Countries**, with Michał Pilc & Beata

Woźniak-Jęchorek. Under Review.

5. **Supply Response in Transition Metal Prices after the Paris Agreement**. Under Review.
6. **Mean Reversion in Exposure Designs: A Window-Shift Test**. Preparing for submission.
7. **Measuring Technological Sovereignty: Who Owns Frontier Technologies?**, with Mohd Shadab Danish. Preparing for submission.
8. **Management and Remote Work**, with Andrea Lamorgese, Andrea Linarello & Fabiano Schivardi. Preparing for submission.
9. **Investor Mandates and Corporate Governance: Evidence from ESG Monitoring in India**. Preparing for submission.
10. **Copyright and Optimal Fair Use**, with Tanay Raj Bhatt. Preparing for submission.
11. **Does Bankruptcy Reform Discipline Firms? Ex-Ante Effects of India's Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code**. Preparing for submission.
12. **The Economic Profile of India's Smaller Cities: Evidence from a New Index**. Preparing for submission.
13. **Intensity Targets vs. Absolute Caps: India's Carbon Credit Trading Scheme**
14. **Services Across Borders: How Firms Organize Remote Work at Scale**
15. **Big India vs. Big U.S.**, with Mert Akan, Nick Bloom, Shelby Buckman & Pete Klenow.
16. **Management in India**, with Mert Akan, Nick Bloom, Shelby Buckman, Pete Klenow, Ananya Kotia & Janak Nabar.
17. **Flexible Work, Occupational Constraints, and the Dynamics of Female Labor Supply**, with Sara Casella & Kieran Larkin.
18. **Family Succession in Firms: Evidence from Italy**, with Alessandra Allocca & Fabiano Schivardi.
19. **The Local Footprint of Million Dollar Plants: Evidence from Three Decades of Satellite Data**, with Christos Makridis.
20. **Carbon Misallocation**
21. **How Firms Pay for Energy Abatement: Evidence from India's Tradable Intensity Standard**
22. **Who speaks for the poor?**, with Yashaswini Shekhawat & Jeff Hammer.

Policy Papers and Reviews

1. **Batting Ahead: Management, Innovation and the Future of Indian Manufacturing**, with Mert Akan, Nick Bloom, Chaitanya Lekharaju, Pete Klenow, PJ Nishok & Janak Nabar. *CTIER Report*, May 2024.
2. **E-retail, Consumer Demand & the Road to Recovery**, with Mohit Chawdhry. *Esya Centre Monograph*, September 2020.
3. **Measuring India's Creative Economy** *Esya Centre Monograph*, June 2020.
4. **Trends in Copyright Infringement and Enforcement**, with Shohini Sengupta & Aishwarya Giridhar. *Esya Centre Monograph*, December 2019.
5. **The Importance of Structured Management Practices**, with Nick Bloom, Erik Brynjolfsson, Itay Saporta-Eksten & John Van Reenen. *MIT Sloan Management Review*, April 18, 2017.

Media and Policy Writing

1. **India Beyond the Metros: Measuring the Economies of Smaller Cities**. *Ideas for India*, 6 October 2026 (English and Hindi).
2. **How the GST Created a Formalisation Cascade**, with Aishwarya Kamboj. *Ideas for India*, 6 April 2026; *The Wire*, 7 April 2026.
3. **Fighting COVID-19 in India**. *LUISS Open*, 11 May 2021 (English and Italian).
4. **Management Practices Boosted Firm Performance in COVID-19 by Facilitating Remote Work: Evidence from Italy**, with Andrea Lamorgese, Andrea Linarello & Fabiano Schivardi. *VoxEU*, 1 May 2021.
5. **Just How Big Is India's Creative Economy?** *LiveMint*, 29 June 2020.
6. **Poverty Beyond Data**. *The Citizen*, 23 May 2020.
7. **Facebook-Jio Deal Has Reignited Questions on Digital Economy, Centrality of Data**. *Financial Express*, 16 May 2020.
8. **Ride the Tech Wave**. *Daily Pioneer*, 1 November 2019.
9. **No Vague Spaces Online**. *Daily Pioneer*, 6 September 2019.
10. **Policy Uncertainty in Indian E-commerce**. *The Leap Blog*, 27 August 2019.
11. **Why Women Must Work**. *Daily Pioneer*, 28 June 2019.
12. **How India Must Fight the Battle Against Piracy**. *Business Standard*, 18 June 2019.
13. **Management and Productivity in India**. *Ideas for India*, 15 March 2018.
14. **'Nudging' People to Make Better Choices**. *Business Standard*, 11 October 2017.
15. **Adding a Piece to the Productivity Puzzle: Management Practices**, with Nick Bloom, Erik Brynjolfsson, Lucia Foster, Ron Jarmin, Itay Saporta-Eksten & John Van Reenen. *VoxEU*, 17 May 2017.
16. **What Drives Differences in Management?** *Harvard Law School Forum on Corporate Governance and Financial Regulation*, 12 May 2017.
17. **How to Manage Those Who Manage Our Money**. *Financial Express*, 23 September 2009.
18. **A Smart Omission of Commission**. *Financial Express*, 15 August 2009.

Teaching

2026	Microeconomics (BA in PPE core, LUISS)
	Behavioral Finance (Masters in MSQE elective, LUISS)
2025	Economics from Outer Space (UG Elective, Stanford University)
	Machine Learning for Finance (Masters in Finance core, LUISS)
	Microeconomics (BA in PPE core, LUISS)
2024	Economics from Outer Space (UG Elective, Stanford University)
	Machine Learning for Finance (Masters in Finance elective, LUISS)
	Microeconomics (BA in PPE core, LUISS)
2023	Satellite Data in Julia (PhD Economics, LUISS)
	Microeconomics (BA in PPE core, LUISS)
	Machine Learning for Finance (Masters in Finance elective, LUISS)
2022	Microeconomics (BA in PPE core, LUISS)
	Machine Learning for Finance (Masters in Finance elective, LUISS)
2021	Microeconomics (BA in PPE core, LUISS)
2020	Statistical Learning (PhD core, LUISS)
	Topics in Big data (PhD elective, LUISS)

2019	Introduction to Statistical Learning (Masters elective, ISI Delhi)
2018	Empirical Corporate Finance, Masters elective, ISI Delhi
	Global Economics, Core MBA - Indian School of Business
	Introduction to Data Science - Chennai Mathematical Institute Summer School
2015	TA for Entrepreneurship, VC & Operation of Privately-held Businesses, Stanford

Technical skills

R, Stata, Python, Julia, SQL; satellite imagery and remote-sensing data; large firm-level and administrative datasets (CMIE Prowess, Annual Survey of Industries, U.S. Census Bureau microdata)

Referee activities

Journals: *American Economic Review, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Management Science, Review of Finance, Research Policy, Industrial and Corporate Change, European Journal of Operational Research, Applied Economics.*
Grants: *National Science Foundation*

Scientific committees

EARIE Conference (2023), LUISS Finance Workshop (2023), Bank of Italy-CEPR-EIEF Conference "Firms in a period of turmoil" (2022), Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development (2021-2023), Emerging Markets Conference

Conferences and invited seminar presentations

2026: 8th EBRD–CEPR Research Symposium "The Frontiers of Finance in Emerging Markets"; Yale Firms, Trade, and Development Conference; Italian Macro with Micro Data Workshop, University of Naples Federico II; Indian School of Business, Hyderabad (forthcoming); Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, Indian Statistical Institute (forthcoming); ISGH (forthcoming); CEPR Paris Symposium (forthcoming)
2025: STEG Annual Conference and Theme Workshops, Oxford University; LMU Munich; Remote Work Conference, Stanford University; LUISS University
2024: Organizational Economics Summer Symposium, Ohlstadt; Remote Work Conference, Stanford University; Empirical Management Conference, Harvard Business School; Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, Indian Statistical Institute
2023: Venice Summer Institute "Decision making in firms: Big Data and Management Practices"; EARIE Rome 2023; Empirical Management Conference 9th Edition, Stanford University
2022: CSEF, Naples; Bank of Italy-EIEF-CEPR "Firms in a period of turmoil"; IIM Bangalore
2021: NBER Summer Institute (Macroeconomics & Productivity); CAED, Coimbra
2020: Empirical Management Conference; LUISS University
2019: Indira Gandhi Institute for Development Research; Centre for Advanced Financial Research and Learning; Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, ISI Delhi
2018: Indian Institute of Management, Bangalore; Finance Research Group, Indira Gandhi Institute for Development Research; Economics Department, Australian National University, Canberra; Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance; Bank of Italy
2017: Wharton Finance Department, University of Pennsylvania; Indian School of Business, Hyderabad; Indian Institute of Management, Udaipur; Annual Conference, Ashoka University; Delhi

Macroeconomics Workshop, ISI Delhi; Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, ISI Delhi
2016: Stanford University, Department of Economics
2015: Kauffman Entrepreneurship Mentoring Workshop
2014: Trans-Atlantic Doctoral Conference, London Business School; RDC Annual Research Conference, US Census Bureau

Service

2026: PhD Admissions Committee, LUISS
2023: Local organizer, CEPR Joint Workshop on Incentives, Management and Organization Entrepreneurship Economics
2022-Present: Department Delegate for Diversity and Inclusion, LUISS
2022: Member of hiring committee for Assistant Professor in Finance, LUISS
2021-Present: Academic Commission, Dual Degree in Economics and Finance (NOVA-LUISS) and Cass Semester Abroad Program (Bayes Business School-LUISS)

Masters Thesis supervision

Co-advisor for the Master's thesis of Paola Rizzitano (2025, LUISS)
Co-advisor for the Master's thesis of Viviana Luisa Palade (2025, LUISS)
Co-advisor for the Master's thesis of Andrea Quaranta (2025, LUISS)
Advisor for the Master's thesis of João Pedro Gaier Ribeiro (2024, LUISS)
Co-advisor for the Master's thesis of Charbel Khazen (2024, LUISS)
Co-advisor for the Master's thesis of Francesco Montone (2024, LUISS)
Co-advisor for the Master's thesis of Francesco Nicholas D'Esposito (2023, LUISS)
Co-advisor for the Master's thesis of Arturo Marucci (2023, LUISS)
Co-advisor for the Master's thesis of Pierluigi Viscillo (2023, LUISS)
Co-advisor for the Master's thesis of Filippo Colapinto (2022, LUISS)
Advisor for the Master's thesis of Arshdeep Duggal (2019, ISI)

Student placements

Yashaswini Shekhawat, NYU Department of Economics (PhD)
Tanay Raj Bhatt, The University of Texas at Austin (PhD)
Giovanni Rizzelli, Aarhus University (PhD)
Prerna Panda, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy (MPP)
Arsh Singh, Google Global Operations

Select public lectures

"Applications of Statistical Learning in Economic Research", Chennai Mathematical Institute (2022)
"AI, Big Data and Machine Learning", Vedica Scholars Programme for Women (2019)
Summer school for Women in Mathematics and Statistics, International Centre for Theoretical Sciences (2019)